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Nextdoor redesigns app
with AI
recommendations, local
news, and real-time
emergency alerts



Neighborhood social app Nextdoor is launching a redesigned version of its service that it's calling the "new Nextdoor." The app is adding local news, real-time alerts, and an AI-powered feature called "Faves" that's designed for discovering local businesses and spots. Nextdoor has also updated its overall design to look more contemporary.

Launched 15 years ago, Nextdoor has long served as a popular platform for neighborhood conversations, helping users connect over things like recommendations for plumbers and suggestions for nearby places to eat. But eventually, its growth stalled and engagement declined as the platform became associated with posts containing [misinformation](#) and [racism](#).

Now, the company is looking to [turn things around](#) and attract more users by making its platform more helpful, useful, and timely. With this redesign, Nextdoor is looking to increase the quality and quantity of local information on the platform, Nextdoor CEO and co-founder Nirav Tolia told TechCrunch.

To bring news to its platform, Nextdoor has partnered with 3,500 local publications across the United States, United Kingdom, and Canada. Notable outlets include the San Francisco Standard, The London Standard, and The Toronto Star.

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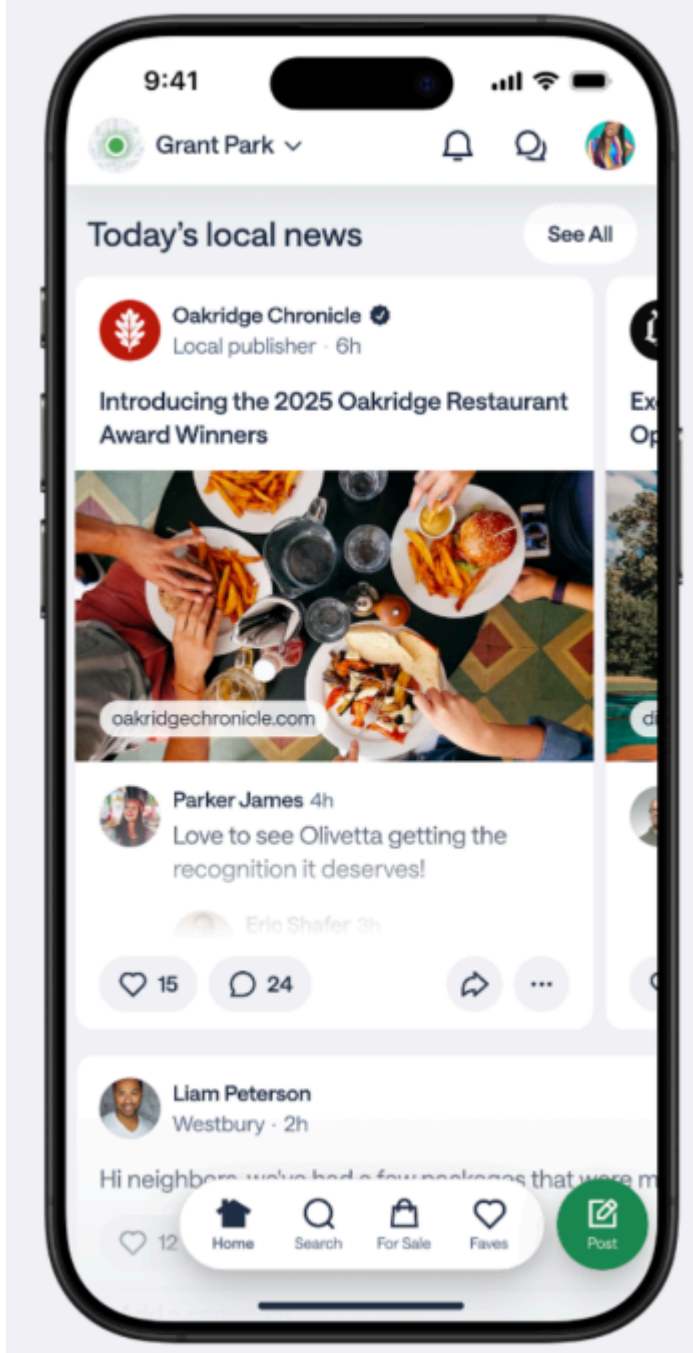


IMAGE CREDITS: NEXTDOOR

“The reason that this is so important for us is historically, Nextdoor has relied 100% on user-generated content, just the content that’s created by your neighbors,” Tolia said. “That’s been a great source of information. But, to really make sure if it’s happening in your neighborhood, we need to bring in local news as well. So this is the first time we’re letting third-party publishers use our distribution.”

Tolia stated that these aren’t commercial agreements, as Nextdoor isn’t paying for the content, nor are the publishers paying the company. Additionally, Nextdoor isn’t hosting the content; it’s simply displaying a headline, a snippet,

and an image, and directing traffic to the publications. Users will be able to discuss the news in a comments section under each post.

Tolia noted that publishers are just the first new type of content coming to Nextdoor, as the platform plans to allow small businesses, schools, and organizations to have native presences in the app in the future as well.



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In terms of the new alerts, Nextdoor now shows real-time updates on things like weather, traffic, power outages, storms, and wildfires. These alerts will appear on a dynamic neighborhood map, allowing neighbors to have timely conversations about safety and preparedness.

The service is partnering with Samdesk and Weather.com, which includes The Weather Channel app and [Weather.com](https://www.weather.com), to power these alerts.

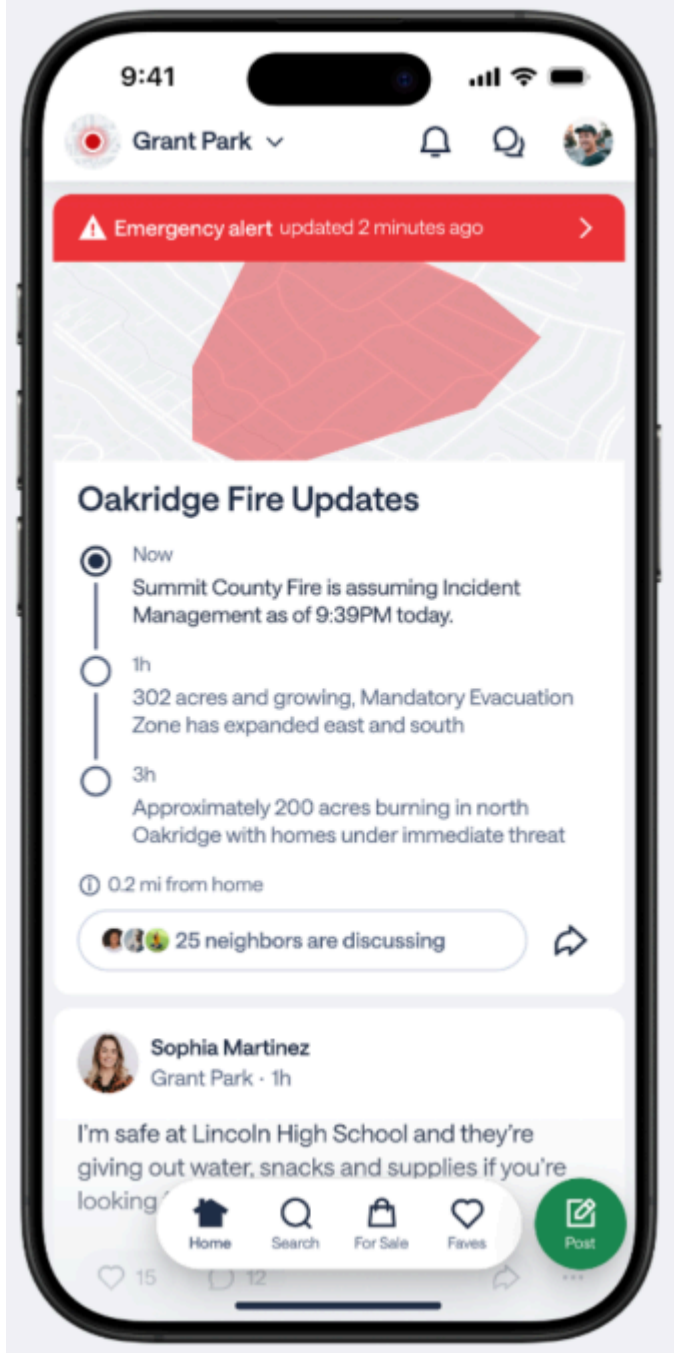


IMAGE CREDITS: NEXTDOOR

“When there’s something that is definitely worth paying attention to, we call that the yellow state, and we’ll put that alert right at the top,” Tolia said. “When there’s something critical, we call that the red state and it’ll take over the whole app, because at that point, you don’t care about the conversations neighbors are having about pickleball. You don’t really care about the new restaurant review that the local publishers put in. You need to get together with your neighbors and help save each other’s lives in some cases.”

Tolia noted that these alerts are hyper-localized because Nextdoor is built on a geospatial platform.

So unlike Amber Alerts that are sent out to everyone in a certain location, Nextdoor says it can personalize its alerts down to the house. For example, if there's a power outage, the app will only send the alert to the people whose power is out.

As for the launch of Faves, Tolia says recommendations from neighbors are more valuable than going on Google or ChatGPT when looking to find a local restaurant or a place to spend time with family over the weekend, which is why Nextdoor is launching the feature. The new Faves feature displays curated lists of recommendations, and also lets you ask specific questions to get suggestions.

“We have an LLM for every neighborhood where we've taken 15 years of neighbor conversations and we can now answer questions about that information in a really compelling way,” Tolia said. “So we have the first, as far as we know, the first truly local AI that's powered by neighbor conversations.”

You can ask questions like, “What is the best place to hike with kids?” and receive a quick, summarized response that pulls information from posts from real users on Nextdoor. Underneath the summary, you can see and click through to the posts that the summary is referencing.

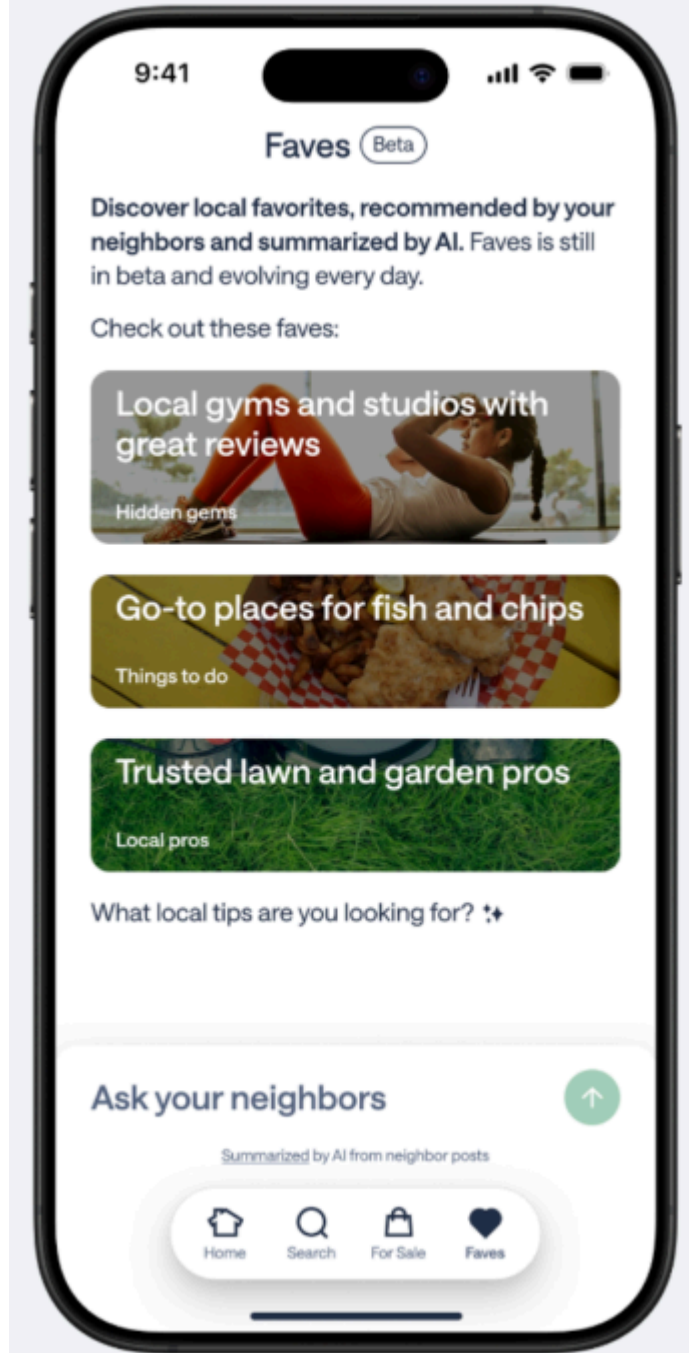


IMAGE CREDITS: NEXTDOOR

“This content is proprietary to Nextdoor,” Tolia said. “We’ve never shared it. It’s not indexed by Google. It’s not available on ChatGPT, and again, because we know where you live, we can target the information to you in the most relevant way.”

Tolia noted that Nextdoor’s unique value is in digitizing and capturing local word-of-mouth, the kind of hyperlocal information that isn’t available through platforms like Google or ChatGPT, because you can only get it from direct conversations.

“I give the funny example of, if you wanted to know all the lemonade stands that kids are operating in

your neighborhood, you can't go to Google Maps and find that," Tolia said. "You can't go to ChatGPT and ask that question, right? The only way is for you to ask your neighbors. And so that's what Nextdoor is all about. So what are we going to do? We're going to recommit to really making this feel hyperlocal. It's really important for us to be seen less as a social network and more as a utility-centric network."

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter |

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

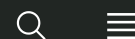
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and communities, including [OhSoWe](#) and [DeHood](#). But there isn't one platform that has been able to be the go-to social platform for local neighborhoods groups. Enter Benchmark-backed [Nextdoor](#), the next startup to throw its hat in the social network for neighborhoods ring.

Nextdoor, which is a private social network for neighborhoods, was co-founded by [Nirav Tolia](#), of Epinions fame. After Epinions (which became Shopping.com), Tolia spend time as an EIR at Benchmark, and then [co-founded FanBase](#), a directory of all things sports.

Now Tolia is on to his next project, Nextdoor, which is launching to the public today, after being in private beta for the past year. On Nextdoor, neighbors create private, Facebook-like websites for their neighborhoods where they can ask questions, get to know one another and exchange local advice and recommendations. Topics of discussion are as varied as local events, school fundraisers, plumber and babysitter recommendations, recent crime activity, upcoming garage sales or even lost pets. Unlike an email listserv or other online group, neighbor posts are organized and archived for future reference.

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Email address

All neighborhoods are private and you have to verify whether you live in a particular neighborhood by entering your address. In fact, the network has a rigorous process in which people can join. Nextdoor uses four methods to verify member addresses. Nextdoor can send a postcard to a new member's address with a unique code printed on it. The code will allow them to log in and verify their account. You can bypass this if you have a listed phone number registered to your home address, and you can request a free phone call to verify your home address. Nextdoor can also instantly verify a new member's home address through a credit card billing address. Or someone who is already a verified member of the website can vouch for a neighbor by inviting them to their website with an email, flyer or postcard invitation.

Information shared on Nextdoor is password-protected and cannot be accessed by those outside the neighborhood or found on Google and other search engines. Via a map for each community, you can see which of your neighbors have joined and who has yet to join. Users can find other neighbors in the resident directory, view a neighborhood map, ask for advice, exchange local recommendations, and share neighborhood information with each other. Neighbors can choose to see and respond to updates via email, or only on the website.

Tolia believes there is a huge opportunity in trying to solve the problem of connecting neighborhoods and communities for the greater good. He explains that most communication is done via email or phone, and there is a need for a private, communications platform for each local neighborhood.

Benchmark partner Bill Gurley agrees. "Nextdoor is different from other social networking sites

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because it was built from the ground up to help neighbors come together in a trusted environment...We have been blown away by the positive response to Nextdoor and believe it is a natural evolution of social networking that will demonstrate the value of building community to neighborhoods everywhere.”



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Nextdoor raised an undisclosed amount of funding from Benchmark Capital and Shasta Ventures. Gurley and Shasta Venture’s Jason Pressman serve on the board of directors, along with outside board member Rich Barton, Chairman and Co-Founder of Zillow.

Ed Everett, Nextdoor’s senior city strategist and the former City Manager of Redwood City, has been working in city administration for a number of years. He says that at the neighborhood level, there was no appealing offering to create an online community for neighborhoods. He believes that because of Nextdoor’s private, geographic-

Over the past year, neighbors in over 175 neighborhoods across 26 states established Nextdoor websites with the goal of creating more connected and safer places to call home. Tolia says engagement was high among users and the platform received positive responses from members.


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Sat, Oct 29, 2011 at 07:00PM


Pumpkin Carving contest
Sun, Oct 30, 2011 at 08:00PM

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Write a message to your neighbors


Jeremy Allen
Last batch of apples

I pulled the last batch of apples from the apple tree this morning. I'll put some out on my porch if anyone wants some. Tracy, I was hoping I'd still have apples left for your Halloween party so we could play "Bobbing for apples", but I don't think they will last.

Posted 9 hours ago in [Buy/Sell/Free](#) (Edit categories) - [Comment](#) - [Like](#) - [Flag](#)


Jesse Barns
Bent hanger on my mountain bike

It looks like I bent the derailleur hanger on my mountain bike. Does anyone know how to fix that, or should I take it to a shop?

Posted 16 hours ago in [Bicycle shop](#) (Edit categories) - [Comment](#) - [Like](#) - [Flag](#)


Phil Banks

I'm not quite the mountain bike expert, but I had to take mine in earlier this year and I think that's what the guy at the bike shop said that I did. He tried to bend it back into place, but I actually had to replace it.

Posted 16 hours ago in [Flag](#)


Jeremy Allen

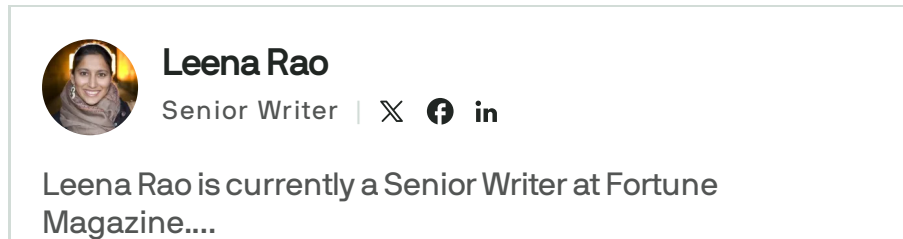
This same thing happened to my bike and yes, you should probably take that in. I tried to bend it back in place myself, and only made it worse. I went to TNL Bikes and they put a new one on for me. Jeff, the owner, is a super nice guy. It's on 13th and Cherry.

Posted 9 hours ago in [Flag](#)

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Monie Moreno

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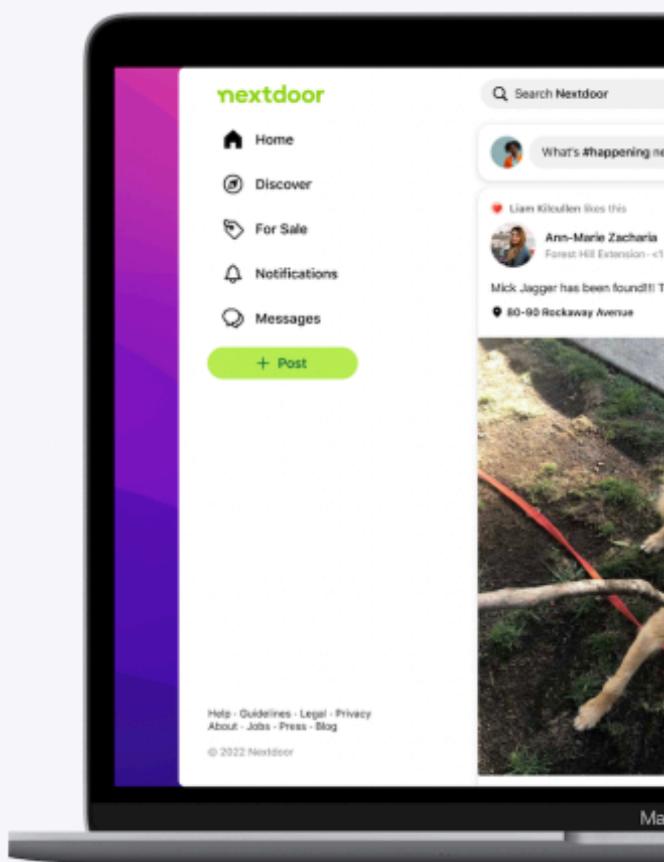


IMAGE CREDITS: NEXTDOOR

APPS



Nextdoor and Vote.org partner to increase voter turnout for US midterms

Aisha Malik — 10:01 AM PDT · September 7, 2022

Nextdoor is partnering with Vote.org to encourage people to participate in the U.S. midterm elections this November, the company [announced](#) on Wednesday. The neighborhood social network says the partnership aims to simplify political engagement and increase voter turnout.

The app will encourage users to verify their voter registration status and find their polling place.

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Leading up to election day on November 8, the social network will identify polling locations and encourage neighbors to help each other get to the polls by carpooling or walking together.

Nextdoor will also remind users to have civil political discourse by displaying pop-ups when hurtful or harmful language is detected or anticipated via predictive technology. The company says its efforts to keep interactions on the platform safe are a balance of human review and technology, both of which will work to flag and remove content that violates Nextdoor's guidelines.

"Change starts in the neighborhood, and while every neighborhood is unique, everyone wants their community to thrive," said Nextdoor CEO Sarah Friar in a statement. "We have an opportunity to strengthen civic engagement while upholding Nextdoor's commitment to voter rights and protections. We're very excited to continue the partnership with Vote.org to help neighbors throughout the upcoming election cycle and beyond."

The company says that by partnering with organizations like Vote.org, it can help share trusted voting resources and provide tools to support civic engagement and neighborhood conversations around local and national politics.

Nextdoor is also partnering with the Advancement Project, the Lawyers Committee for Civil Rights and the NAACP to share information about election rights and protections.

Earlier this year, Nextdoor [revamped its app](#) with new profiles and more community-building features. The changes came as the social network developed a reputation for racial profiling over the years, which led to the company [releasing](#) specific features to address this. The revamp was part of

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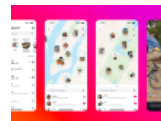
AI



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Nextdoor's larger vision and its goal to create a welcoming neighborhood both online and offline.



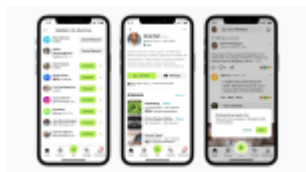
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Nextdoor revamps with new profiles, feed and more community-building features



Neighborhood social network Nextdoor is revamping its product. The changes, which aim to simplify the app and promote better relationships between neighbors, follow last year's hire of Nextdoor's

new Head of Product Kiran Prasad, who joined the company after serving at LinkedIn. Combined, the updates are laying the groundwork for a new strategic direction for [Continue](#)

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Aisha Malik

Consumer News Reporter | [X](#)

Aisha is a consumer news reporter at TechCrunch. Prior to joining the publication in 2021, she was a telecom reporte...

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